CHAPTER 8

ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAYS

OBJECTIVES

To write academic texts, you need to master certain skills.

In this chapter, you will learn to:

- Analyze two argumentative essays
- Examine the elements of a well-structured argument
- Structure an argument using block and point-by-point organization
- Use modals, phrasal modals, and the subjunctive mode
- Rebut counterarguments effectively
- Write, revise, and edit an essay on a controversial issue



Many people strongly oppose research on animals.

INTRODUCTION

Controversy and, therefore, argument appear in almost every academic field: in discussions of new scientific research; in competing views on economic theory; in interpretations of art, literature, music, and movies; in debates about philosophy; concerns over best practices in education, and so on. Likewise, controversy and argument are widespread in everyday discussions of virtually every subject, from politics to business and sports, or any other subject you can think of.

An argument, however, is not a fight. Instead, an **argumentative essay** is an attempt to convince others that a particular point of view on a topic is or is not correct. Creating a sound argument is thus an essential skill both inside and outside of college or the university. While argumentative writing applies to any topic, the writing models will focus on controversy related to animal research and the costs of a college education.

ANALYZING THE MODELS

The first model essay presents an argument in favor of animal testing. The second model responds to arguments that a college degree is no longer a good investment.

Read the models. Then answer the questions.

Writing Model 1

A Scientist: I Am the Enemy

Ronald M. Kline M.D.

1 I am the enemy! One of those hated, cold-hearted physician-scientists involved in animal research. How strange, for I have never thought of myself as an evil person. I became a pediatrician because of my love for children and my desire to keep them healthy. During medical school and residency,[1] however, I saw many children die of leukemia,[2] prematurity,[3] and traumatic[4] injury—circumstances against which medicine has made tremendous progress, but still has far to go. More important, I also saw children, alive and healthy, thanks to advances in medical science such as infant respirators,[5] strong antibiotics, new surgical techniques, and the entire field of organ transplantation.[6] My desire to tip the scales in favor of healthy, happy children drew me to medical research.

(continued on next page)

[1] **residency:** the period in which a doctor continues training in a hospital after completing medical school
[2] **leukemia:** a type of cancer that affects the blood stream, often causing death
[3] **prematurity:** being born before the body's organs are developed enough to allow normal survival
[4] **traumatic:** seriously damaging
[5] **respirators:** devices to help people breathe
[6] **transplantation:** replacement of a body part, usually donated from another person

2 My accusers claim that I torture animals for the sole purpose of advancing my career. My experiments supposedly have no relevance to medicine and are easily replaced by computer simulation. Meanwhile, an apathetic public barely watches, convinced that the issue has no significance, and publicity-conscious politicians increasingly give way to the demands of the activists.

3 We in medical research have also been unacceptably apathetic. We have allowed the most extreme animal-rights protesters to seize the initiative and frame the issue as one of "animal fraud." We have been complacent in our belief that a knowledgeable public would sense the importance of animal research to the public health. Perhaps we have been mistaken in not responding to the emotional tone of the argument created by those sad posters of animals by waving equally sad posters of children dying of leukemia or cystic fibrosis.[7]

4 Much is made of the pain caused to these animals in the name of medical science. The animal-rights activists contend that this is evidence of our cruel and brutal nature. A more reasonable argument, however, can be advanced in our defense. Life is often cruel, both to animals and human beings. Teenagers get thrown from the back of a pickup truck and suffer severe head injuries. Toddlers, barely able to walk, find themselves at the bottom of a swimming pool while a parent checks the mail. Physicians hoping to alleviate the pain and suffering that these tragedies cause have but three choices: create an animal model of the injury or disease and use that model to understand the process and test new therapies, experiment on human beings—some experiments will succeed, most will fail—or finally, leave medical knowledge unchanged, hoping that accidental discoveries will lead us to the advances.

5 Some animal-rights activists would suggest a fourth choice, claiming that computer models can simulate animal experiments, thus making the actual experiments unnecessary. Computers can simulate, reasonably well, the effects of well-understood principles on complex systems, as in the application of the laws of physics to airplane and automobile design. However, when the principles themselves are in question, as is the case with the complex biological systems under study, computer modeling alone is of little value.

6 One of the terrifying effects of the effort to restrict the use of animals in medical research is that its impact will not be felt for many years and decades:[8] drugs that might have been discovered will not be; surgical techniques that might have been developed will not be; and fundamental biological processes that might have been understood will remain mysteries. There is the danger that self-serving political solutions will be found to satisfy a vocal minority, while the consequences of those decisions will not be apparent until long after the decisions are made and the decision-making forgotten.

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[7] **cystic fibrosis:** a serious medical condition that makes breathing and eating difficult
[8] **decades:** groups of ten

7 Fortunately, most of us enjoy good health, and the tragedy of watching one's child die has become a rare experience. Yet our good fortune should not make us unappreciative of the health we enjoy or the advances that make it possible. Vaccines, antibiotics, insulin, and drugs to treat heart disease, hypertension,[9] and stroke are all based on animal research. Most complex surgical procedures, such as coronary-artery bypass and organ transplantation, are initially developed in animals. Presently undergoing animal studies are techniques to insert genes in humans in order to replace the defective ones found to be the cause of so much disease. These studies will effectively end if animal research is severely restricted.

8 In America today, death has become an event isolated from our daily existence—out of the sight and thoughts of most of us. As a doctor who has watched many children die, and their parents grieve, I am particularly angered by people capable of so much compassion for a dog or a cat, but with seemingly so little for a dying human being. These people seem so insulated from the reality of human life and death and what it means.

9 Make no mistake, however: I am not advocating the needlessly cruel treatment of animals. To the extent that the animal-rights movement has made us more aware of the needs of these animals and made us search harder for suitable alternatives, they have made a significant contribution. But if the more radical members of this movement are successful in limiting further research, their efforts will bring about a tragedy that will cost many lives. The real question is whether an apathetic majority can be aroused to protect its future against a vocal, but misdirected, minority.

Source: Adapted from Kline, Ronald M. "A Scientist: I Am the Enemy."

[9] **hypertension:** abnormally high blood pressure

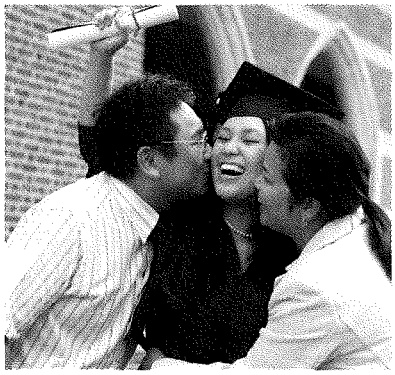
Questions about the Model

1. Why does Dr. Kline state that he is "the enemy" in the first sentence? According to him, who thinks he is the enemy?
2. Who is the primary audience for this essay—animal rights advocates or people without strong opinions about laboratory experiments on animals?
3. Look at the first and second sentences of paragraphs 1 to 6. Whose arguments do they address—Dr. Kline's or those of animal rights advocates? Do the sentences that follow agree or disagree with the opening arguments?
4. In what way does Dr. Kline change his approach in paragraphs 6 to 9?
5. Does Dr. Kline agree with any of the arguments made by animal rights advocates? If so, where and why?
6. Can you find Dr. Kline's thesis in paragraph 9? Underline the statement.

Writing Model 2

The Value of a College Degree

Kathleen Porter



1 The rapidly rising cost of higher education is causing many to question the value of continuing education beyond high school. Many wonder whether the high cost of tuition, the cost of choosing college over full-time employment, and the accumulation of thousands of dollars of debt is, in the long run, worth the investment. The risk is especially large for low-income families who have a difficult time making ends meet without the additional burden of college tuition and fees.

2 In order to determine whether higher education is worth the investment, it is useful to examine what is known about the value of higher education and the rates of return on investment to both the individual and to society.

3 There is considerable support for the argument that the return on investment in higher education is high enough to justify the high cost of pursuing a college degree. Though the difference in earnings between college and high school graduates varies over time, college graduates, on average, earn more than high school graduates. According to the Census Bureau, over an adult's working life, high school graduates earn an average of $1.2 million; associate's degree holders earn about $1.6 million; and those with a bachelor's degree earn about $2.1 million (Day and Newburger, 2002). These statistics support the contention that, though the cost of higher education is significant, a college graduate's return on investment in his or her education is high enough to justify the cost.

4 While it is clear that investment in a college degree, especially for those students in the lowest income brackets, is a financial burden, the long-term benefits to individuals, as well as to society at large, appear to far outweigh the costs.

Source: Adapted from Porter, Kathleen. "The Value of a College Degree."

Questions about the Model

1. What is the purpose of Paragraph 1? How does it relate to Paragraph 2?
2. Which sentence in Paragraph 3 makes the central claim of the argument? What information supports this claim?
3. What conclusion does the argument draw?
4. Where do arguments against Kathleen Porter's position appear in her report?

Noticing Vocabulary: Synonyms, 2

As you know, writers broaden their vocabulary through reading. When they encounter a new word, they may look it up in a dictionary. Other times, however, they can determine the meaning of a word from the context of the sentence in which it appears.

PRACTICE 1 Defining Terms from Context

Look at Writing Model 1 on pages 147–149. Find the numbered words. Use the context to help you decide which synonym best defines each numbered word.

i	1. apathetic *(paragraph 2)*	a. choice
	2. initiative *(paragraph 3)*	b. imitate
	3. complacent *(paragraph 3)*	c. treatment
	4. alleviate *(paragraph 4)*	d. unworried
	5. therapy *(paragraph 5)*	e. damaged
	6. simulate *(paragraph 6)*	f. lessen
	7. impact *(paragraph 6)*	g. effect
	8. fundamental *(paragraph 6)*	h. basic
	9. defective *(paragraph 7)*	i. unconcerned
	10. alternative *(paragraph 9)*	j. advantage

GRAMMAR

An argument often requires that you make suggestions, recommendations, and even demands. These expressions usually include **modal verbs**, **phrasal modal verbs**, and the use of the **subjunctive mode**.

MODAL VERBS

Modal verbs express ability, possibility, probability, necessity, advice, and recommendations. A modal verb has only one form and is always followed by the base form of the verb.

Rules	Examples
1. Use *can* and *could* to express present and past ability.	We can find better treatments for leukemia. I became a researcher so I could help cure disease.
2. Use *should* to offer advice or make a recommendation.	We should consider better ways to conduct laboratory experiments.
3. Use *must* to express necessity. **Note:** the negative of *must* means it is **prohibited** to do something.	We must continue research using laboratory animals. We must not allow extremists to limit research. You must not kill these animals without a good reason for doing so!
4. Use *may*, *might*, and *could* to express probability or possibility.	The results may save lives. New discoveries might happen at any time. They could lead to improvements in treatment.

PRACTICE 2 **Writing Sentences with Modals**

Use the modal verbs in parentheses to write another sentence.

1. Medical research on stem cells has led to important treatments of defective organs. (must) We must make these treatments easily available.

2. We are not conducting enough research into the treatment of autism. (could)

3. College graduates earn more money over their lifetimes than high school graduates. (should)

4. There are several ways to help students afford the cost of a college education. (might)

5. A cure for all forms of cancer will certainly not occur soon. (may)

6. Computer simulations are useful in conducting some types of medical research. (might not)

7. There are several ways to get to school. (could)

8. Texting while driving has been proven to cause many accidents and even deaths. (must not)

PHRASAL MODALS

Another tool for making recommendations, suggestions, and demands is using a **phrasal modal** (or semi-auxiliary). A phrasal modal consists of two or more separate words and functions somewhat like a modal verb. It expresses ability, offers advice, makes recommendations, or discusses possibilities or probabilities. However, unlike a modal verb, which has one form, phrasal modals change according to person and aspect.

RULES	EXAMPLES
1. Use *be able to* + [the base form of the verb] for expressing achievement.	They have been able to make significant changes in research methods.
2. Use *be likely to* + [the base form of the verb] for expressing probability.	This change is likely to have profound effects.
3. Use *be going to* + [the base form of the verb] for expressing certainty with.	This change is going to benefit millions of people.
4. Use *have to* + [the base form of the verb] for expressing necessity.	We have to conduct more research.
Note: The negative of *have to* means something is not necessary. It differs from *must not*, which means it is prohibited.	We don't have to use animals in all experiments.
5. Use *had better* for expressing warning.	You had better be careful when working with dangerous chemicals.
6. Use *would rather* (without *to*) for expressing preference.	Most students would rather apply for a scholarship than take out a loan.

PRACTICE 3 Using Phrasal Modals

Choose five of the sentences you wrote in Practice 2 and rewrite them using phrasal modals.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

SUBJUNCTIVE MODE

One other structure commonly used when making suggestions, recommendations, and demands is the **subjunctive mode**. A statement in the subjunctive mode includes two clauses:

- the first clause includes a verb such as *suggest, propose, insist, recommend, request, require, stipulate, specify,* and *demand*
- the second clause begins with *that* and includes a short infinitive—irrespective of the time of the action

First Clause	Second Clause
I suggest . . .	that computer simulations be used.
I recommend . . .	that he apply for a scholarship.
I request . . .	that experiments continue. (Note the implied future time.)
I demand (insist) . . .	that he stop immediately.
The college requires . . .	that each student complete two years of a foreign language.

PRACTICE 4 **Using the Subjunctive**

Write a statement in the subjunctive after each of the following sentences. Use a different verb from the chart above in each statement.

1. Juan has only a high school degree. I recommend that he get a college education.

2. We are not doing enough research in cures for rare types of cancer.

3. This approach to the issue is clearly wrong.

4. The cost of a college education is too expensive.

5. The instructor will not accept handwritten essays.

6. We cannot allow industry to pollute the environment.

ORGANIZATION

An argumentative essay is somewhat similar to the summary / response format discussed in Chapter 7. You present your ideas and opinions about a topic in which there is disagreement or controversy, and attempt to persuade your reader that your viewpoint on the topic is correct. However, unlike in summary / response essay, you must present opposing sides of the issue and demonstrate why one side, or position, is the better one. In short, argumentation requires that you present and support your own ideas while responding to ideas that oppose them.



The viewpoint you support is called your **argument**. The opposing viewpoint is called a **counterargument**. You cannot ignore a counterargument or counterarguments. Instead, you must state and **rebut** (that is, respond to by disproving, or raising doubt about) the claims of the opposition. Acknowledging these counterarguments demonstrates to your readers your knowledge of the issue, and that you are being thoughtful, open-minded, and fair. In this way, readers are more likely to respect your point of view. However, before writing, you will need to determine who your readers are likely to be and what their stance, if any, is on the issue, which will affect how you support your position. This point will be addressed later in the chapter.

There are two common organizational patterns for argumentative essays: **block** organization and **point-by-point** organization.

BLOCK ORGANIZATION

In block organization, the counterarguments and rebuttals, and arguments and support are divided into different sections, or **blocks** of paragraphs presented separately. A diagram of block organization, with examples from Writing Model 1, looks like this:

Introductory Paragraph

The opening paragraph explains the controversy surrounding the topic, and states your position on the issue (thesis).

↓

First Group of Body Paragraphs (Block One)

In the opening paragraphs of the body (Block 1), there is a summary of the counterarguments followed by rebuttals to them. The rebuttals include explanations, evidence, and examples.

- **Paragraph 2:** animal rights activists claim animals are tortured, research results not relevant for humans, computer simulation makes actual experiments unnecessary
- **Paragraph 3:** rebuttal—research is important, opposing side's is emotional, and not well-reasoned
- **Paragraph 4:** rebuttal—world is cruel to animals and humans alike; doctors trying to alleviate animal suffering
- **Paragraph 5:** rebuttal—computer models are based on known principles; animal experiments are based on unknown principles

↓

Second Group of Body Paragraphs (Block Two)

The latter body paragraphs (Block 2) present the author's arguments and supporting evidence and examples.

- **Paragraph 6:** lack of experimentation impacts medicine for decades
- **Paragraph 7:** lifesaving medical procedures are created through animal research
- **Paragraph 8:** activists have more compassion for animals than people

↓

Concluding Paragraph

The final paragraph restates your viewpoint and usually includes a summary of your argument.

POINT-BY-POINT ORGANIZATION

In an essay that is organized in a point-by-point pattern, each key idea from both sides of an issue is examined in a single paragraph. You rebut the opposing claim and provide support for your argument.

Introductory Paragraph

The first paragraph frames the issue, explains the controversy surrounding the topic, and states your position on the issue (thesis).

↓

Body Paragraphs

In each paragraph of the body, you state a claim from the opposing side, then rebut with a claim from your argument.

Paragraph 2: statement of the other side's first counterargument and your rebuttal

Paragraph 3: statement of the other side's second counterargument and your rebuttal

Paragraph 4: statement of the other side's third counterargument and your rebuttal

↓

Concluding Paragraph

The final paragraph restates your viewpoint and includes a summary of your argument. It also often includes a call to action.

Of course, these diagrams present a slightly simplified and theoretical version of argumentative essays. An essay may not follow these patterns exactly. For example, the body paragraphs may reverse the point-to-point pattern: stating the writer's argument, followed by a counterargument, and then the rebuttal.

You can use whichever organizational patterns you wish, but it may be helpful to keep these two points in mind as you decide:

- Block organization, because of its divided approach (one side, then the other), works well for short papers and issues that are not very complex.
- Point-by point organization, which allows the writer to examine issues in depth, is better suited for complex issues and longer papers.

THE INTRODUCTORY PARAGRAPH(S)

In the opening paragraph or paragraphs, it is important that you **frame the issue**, that is, introduce the arguments for and against the issue while stating your position. In short, the framing of an argument moves from "on the one hand" to "on the other hand," with the argument or counterargument occupying either position. For example, look at the opening paragraphs of Writing Model 2, which present the counterargument and the argument before moving into its thesis:

COUNTERARGUMENT The rapidly rising cost of higher education is causing many to question the value of continuing education beyond high school. . . .

INTRODUCTION TO ARGUMENT In order to determine whether higher education is worth the investment, it is useful to examine what is known about the value of higher education and the rates of return on investment to both the individual and to society.

THESIS There is considerable support for the argument that the return on investment in higher education is high enough to justify the high cost of pursuing a college degree.

Verbs for Framing an Issue

A convincing argument in part depends on a mature writing style and accurate characterization of the issues. Do not overuse the verb "says" in introducing an argument or counterargument. Aside from being repetitive, it does not indicate the attitude of the writer and the strength of his or her position. There is, for example, a great difference between "The writer insists" and "The writer suggests." The following lists of verbs will be helpful in framing an issue, introducing an argument, and responding to a counterargument.

Taking a Strong Position	Taking a Neutral or Less Emphatic Position
advocate	agree/disagree with
allege	favor
argue	imply
believe	indicate
claim	question
contend	recommend
deny	state
insist	suggest
maintain	support
reject	wonder

PRACTICE 5 **Using Verbs for Arguments or Counterarguments**

A **Complete the statements with a verb from the chart.**

1. I _____ that the prices we pay for fruits and vegetables are outrageous!
2. Despite all the evidence against Mr. Wilson's position, he still _____ that he is correct.
3. I _____ the argument of Mr. Wilson.
4. Although Mr. Wilson does not say so directly, his statement _____ that he has some biases against certain people.
5. I _____ that the best course of action is to stop this behavior.
6. In order to address this problem, I _____ that we take immediate action.
7. The most recent research _____ that we must change our policies.
8. No matter what Mr. Wilson _____, I _____ that his argument makes little sense.

B **Work with a partner or in a small group. Compare your sentences in Part A. If you have chosen different verbs, discuss the change in meaning that results from your choice.**

For writing guides to help you frame an argument, see Appendix A, page 193.

BODY PARAGRAPHS

Once you have framed the issue and introduced your position on the controversy, you can follow one of two organizational patterns:

- At the beginning of each paragraph, introduce the counterargument and then state and develop your claim in response.
- At the beginning of each paragraph, state and support your claim and then present and acknowledge or respond to a counterargument.

PRACTICE 6 Locating Arguments and Reponses

Work with a partner or in a small group. Return to Writing Model 1 on pages 147–149 and look at paragraphs 6–8, which form Block Two of the argument. Find the arguments and counterarguments. Then summarize both.

PARAGRAPH 6

Argument: "One of the terrifying effects of the effort to restrict the use of animals in medical research is that its impact will not be felt for many years and decades. . . ."

Counterargument: _____

_____

PARAGRAPH 7

Argument: _____

_____

Counterargument: _____

_____

PARAGRAPH 8

Argument: _____

_____

Counterargument: _____

_____

CONCLUDING PARAGRAPH

As in other types of essays, the conclusion of an argument typically returns to the thesis, summarizes the main ideas, and may make a call for action. Here are examples from the two writing models on pages 147–150.

WRITING MODEL 1

. . . But if the more radical members of this movement are successful in limiting further research, their efforts will bring about a tragedy that will cost many lives. The real question is whether an apathetic majority can be aroused to protect its future against a vocal, but misdirected, minority.

WRITING MODEL 2

. . . While it is clear that investment in a college degree, especially for those students in the lowest income brackets, is a financial burden, the long-term benefits to individuals, as well as to society at large, appear to far outweigh the costs.

PLANNING YOUR ARGUMENT

Framing the argument is partly based on anticipating the responses of your audience. Some readers will easily agree with your claims. Others will demand more evidence than you have provided. Still others will disagree with your claims and offer counterarguments. Anticipating the attitude of your audience, and the arguments they might make, are essential steps in the writing process.

KNOWING YOUR AUDIENCE

Your readers can be classified into three general categories: supportive, neutral, and antagonistic.

The Supportive Audience

These readers are already familiar with the issue and tend to agree with your position. They are looking for additional reasons to support this position, especially if you can rebut the opposing arguments. Because they are receptive to what you have to say, you need not provide a great many facts, statistics, or examples—but you should provide some support for your claims.

The Neutral Audience

These readers may be interested in the issue, but have not formed strong opinions about it. They are most likely to accept your claims if you support them well and do not use overly emotional language, which would likely make them suspicious of your fairness and objectivity.

The Antagonistic Audience

These readers strongly disagree with your position. Your best approach with such readers is to strongly support your claims with facts, statistics, and examples—and avoid any emotionally charged language. Present yourself as a reasonable and logical person so they have less reason to dismiss your arguments.

TRY IT OUT! Conduct a short survey about these issues. Copy and complete the form on a separate sheet of paper, and then tabulate the results. Use the results to decide whether your class is friendly, neutral, or antagonistic to each issue.

Cell phone use should be banned from public transportation.

❑ strongly agree ❑ agree ❑ neutral
❑ disagree ❑ strongly disagree

People under the age of eighteen should not be allowed to play video games.

❑ strongly agree ❑ agree ❑ neutral
❑ disagree ❑ strongly disagree

People should eat only organic food.

❑ strongly agree ❑ agree ❑ neutral
❑ disagree ❑ strongly disagree

The driving age should be raised to twenty-one.

❑ strongly agree ❑ agree ❑ neutral
❑ disagree ❑ strongly disagree

RESPONDING TO COUNTERARGUMENTS

Responding to counterarguments is essential to persuading your readers, but how, exactly, can you respond? You have several choices.

Disagree

Claim that the counterargument is wrong, because:

- it misinterprets or ignores the facts
- its claims are exaggerated
- its reasoning is not sound
- its solution to a problem will not work

In Writing Model 1, Dr. Kline maintains that the opposing argument is exaggerated and unreasonable and then responds:

> Much is made of the pain caused to these animals in the name of medical science. The animal-rights activists contend that this is evidence of our cruel and brutal nature. A more reasonable argument, however, can be advanced in our defense. Life is often cruel, both to animals and human beings.

Concede a point, but disagree nonetheless

Acknowledge that part of the counterargument is valid, but disagree with the remainder of the argument. For example, Dr. Kline concedes that the animal rights advocates have made scientists "more aware of the needs of these animals, and made us search harder for suitable alternatives." Nevertheless, he warns that limiting further research "will bring about a tragedy that will cost many lives."

Agree and disagree, but take a position

Acknowledge the validity of both sides of the issue, but then claim that one side is the better choice—or the least harmful choice. In Writing Model 2, Kathleen Porter agrees in part with the counterargument, but then expresses her disagreement:

> While it is clear that investment in a college degree, especially for those students in the lowest income brackets, is a financial burden, the long-term benefits to individuals, as well as to society at large, appear to far outweigh the costs.

For writing guides to help you respond to counterarguments, see Appendix A, page 194.

TRY IT OUT! **Return to Practice 6 on page 160, in which you framed an argument. Write a full body paragraph in support of one side or the other. But also respond to the counterargument, using or adapting one or more of the guides.**

PREPARATION FOR WRITING

The late United States Senator Daniel Patrick Moynihan once said, "Everyone is entitled to his own opinion, but not his own facts." So it is with writing an argument. You cannot simply state your opinion without backing it up. While some of the backing may come from your own personal experience, most will come from facts, figures, and quotations from authorities that you find through research. Likewise, since you should not—indeed cannot—ignore the counterarguments of others, you must anticipate and prepare responses to these counterarguments, which also may arise largely through research.

FINDING SUPPORT FOR YOUR ARGUMENT

Apply the research skills and methods described in Chapters 4, 5, and 6. Narrow your topic, visit the library, and search the Internet.

1. If your Internet searches produce too many irrelevant websites, experiment with different topic headings. Add the phrases "in favor of" or "supporting" (or "against" or "opposing") to the key words in your argument. For example, a Google search using the heading "against cell phones" will likely produce subcategories such as "Against cell phones in school," "Against Cell Phones While Driving," and so on.

(continued on next page)

2. Scan the articles and websites for relevant information. Download (or bookmark) the potentially most useful ones.
3. Look also for cross-references in the articles you have located. These additional sources may prove as useful as, or even more useful than, the ones you began with.
4. Then read the most relevant articles with care, looking for important data and material worth summarizing (especially if you synthesize information from more than one source). On material you download and print or photocopy, highlight or underline sections you might paraphrase or quote.
5. Keep an open mind. Quite often your research will lead you to amend your argument, especially if you discover that the issue is more complicated than you anticipated originally.
6. Use note cards to keep track of your sources and the material you have highlighted.

RESEARCH THE COUNTERARGUMENTS

Apply what you've learned about researching counterarguments.

1. Look carefully at counterarguments mentioned in the materials you have found. Note how the writer rebuts them. These rebuttals may be worth quoting.
2. Do a second Internet search for articles taking the opposing position to yours. Again, you can also add "in favor of" or "against" to the search headings.
3. Again highlight important material. Quote the passages you are going to rebut. Readers may be suspicious that short summaries or mere paraphrases have distorted the person's ideas. Keep the quotations short, however.
4. Now organize your note cards into categories such as "arguments for" and "arguments against."

These research skills apply not only to argumentative essays, but also to the writing of the term paper, which will be discussed in Chapter 9.

TRY IT OUT! **Do an Internet search on Writing Model 1. Find at least three articles in favor of and three articles against the use of animals in research. List the titles and URLs (web locations).**

In Favor

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Against

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Applying Vocabulary: Using Synonyms, 2

Most words in English have more than one grammatical function: as a verb, noun, adjective, or adverb. In most cases, the word changes its form from function to function, but in some cases, it remains the same (for example, the word *love* takes the same form as both a noun and a verb). Using the forms correctly is therefore essential.

PRACTICE 7 Using Correct Grammatical Forms

Complete each of the following sentences with the appropriate grammatical form of the word supplied—noun, adjective, or verb. Use your dictionary if necessary.

1. *apathetic:* People are too indifferent to the suffering of the poor. We cannot allow such apathy.
2. *therapy:* This treatment has many _____ effects.
3. *defective:* Each product must be checked carefully for _____ before it is sold to consumers.
4. *impact:* An increase in college tuition greatly _____ most students.
5. *alternative:* The main road is closed, so commuters must take an _____ route.
6. *initiative:* The ancient Greeks are thought to have _____ the practice of democracy.

WRITING ASSIGNMENT

Your assignment for this chapter is to write an argumentative essay on a controversial topic. Choose a topic that interests you or that you feel strongly about. Alternatively, you can use one of the topics below. Follow the steps in the writing process.

Possible Topics

- Medical research on animals should be discontinued.
- College tuition should be lowered and paid for by increases in taxes.
- There should be/there should not be quotas on the numbers and specific nationalities of people immigrating to this country.
- Computer use by children and adolescents must be carefully supervised and monitored.



STEP 1: Explore your topic, audience, and purpose.

- Write a rough draft statement of your position on the topic. You will revise it later, after investigating the issue further.
- Determine who the audience is for your argument. Are these people supportive, neutral, or antagonistic to your position?
- Decide on the goal of your argument. For example, do you want your audience merely to accept your viewpoint or to take some action regarding the issue?
- Research the issue in the library or on the Internet.



STEP 2: Prewrite to get ideas.

- Brainstorm a list of the main arguments in support of your position. What evidence or examples can you provide—or do you need to find?
- Brainstorm a list of the main arguments that might oppose your position. Consider possible rebuttals to each.
- List the claims of the counterarguments, and brainstorm your responses.

Writing Tip

It may be useful to discuss the issue with another person. Hearing another viewpoint may help you understand and respond to the counterarguments.

Return to your original position statement and make any changes that are needed.



STEP 3: Organize your ideas.

- Use your position statement to write a preliminary thesis statement.
- Make an outline of the arguments and counterarguments based on either point-by-point or block organization.



STEP 4: Write the first draft.

- In the introductory paragraphs, frame the issue with a summary of the problem and the arguments.
- In the body, develop each claim in support of your position, using examples, facts and figures, and quotations from source material.
- Respond to the counterarguments in ways described in this chapter.
- End with a return to the summary and perhaps a call to action.



STEP 5: Revise the draft.

- Exchange papers with a partner, and give each other feedback on your papers. Use the Chapter 8 Peer Review on page 239 to guide your feedback.
- Carefully consider your partner's feedback. If you agree with it, revise your paper by marking the changes on your first draft.



STEP 6: Edit and proofread.

- Use the Chapter 8 Writer's Self-Check on page 240 to help you look for and correct errors in grammar, mechanics, and sentence structure.



STEP 7: Write a new draft.

- Revise the draft, incorporating all the changes you want to make.
- Make sure the draft is legible and follows the format your instructor has provided.
- Proofread the draft so that it is error free.
- Hand in the essay to your instructor.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

In this chapter, you learned to:

- ❍ Analyze two argumentative essays
- ❍ Examine the elements of a well-structured argument
- ❍ Structure an argument using block and point-by-point organization
- ❍ Use modals, phrasal modals, and the subjunctive mode
- ❍ Rebut counterarguments effectively
- ❍ Write, revise, and edit an essay on a controversial issue

Which ones can you do well? Mark them ✓

Which ones do you need to practice more? Mark them ✗

EXPANSION

TIMED WRITING

In this expansion, you will write a short argument in class. You will have 50 minutes. To complete the expansion, you will need to budget your time accordingly. Follow this procedure.

1. Carefully read the writing prompt. Make sure you understand the question or task. Then write a thesis statement reflecting your opinion on the topic. (5 minutes)
2. Brainstorm to generate ideas or make a rough outline to organize your ideas. (5 minutes)
3. Write your argument. Be sure to frame the issue in the opening paragraph, support your main arguments in the body, and respond to the counterarguments. (30 minutes)
4. Check your paper for errors. Correct any mistakes. (10 minutes)
5. Give your paper to your instructor.

Writing Tip

One way to save time in the early stages of writing is to omit the supporting material, inserting short notes to remind you about where to place it in the later stages of the writing process.

Prompt: Should the current grading practices in your school be altered or remain the same? If you think they should change, how should they change, and what effects would these changes have?

TAKING THE OPPOSITE POSITION

Return to the topic of the Writing Assignment you completed earlier and advocate the opposing side to your argument. Do further research if needed. This task will require that you reverse everything you have done previously: your arguments will now become the counterarguments, and the counterarguments will become your arguments.